CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE IN PAYMENTS

23%

reported technical problems when paying in person

What 40,981 survey responses reveal about payment friction and customer needs.

At least once in the past month. Valid n = 39,404.

An independent Python case study
Daniel Pantie

40,981 consumers.
18 countries.

Real responses from the ECB SPACE 2024 public-use file

ONE ROW PER PERSON

Payment diary and accompanying questions.

TWO FIELDWORK ROUNDS

Autumn 2023 and spring 2024.

DIFFERENT RECALL PERIODS

In-store problems: past month.
Online difficulties: diary-day payments.

The public file excludes Germany and the Netherlands. Czechia is outside the survey.

Cashless is the preferred option for 58%

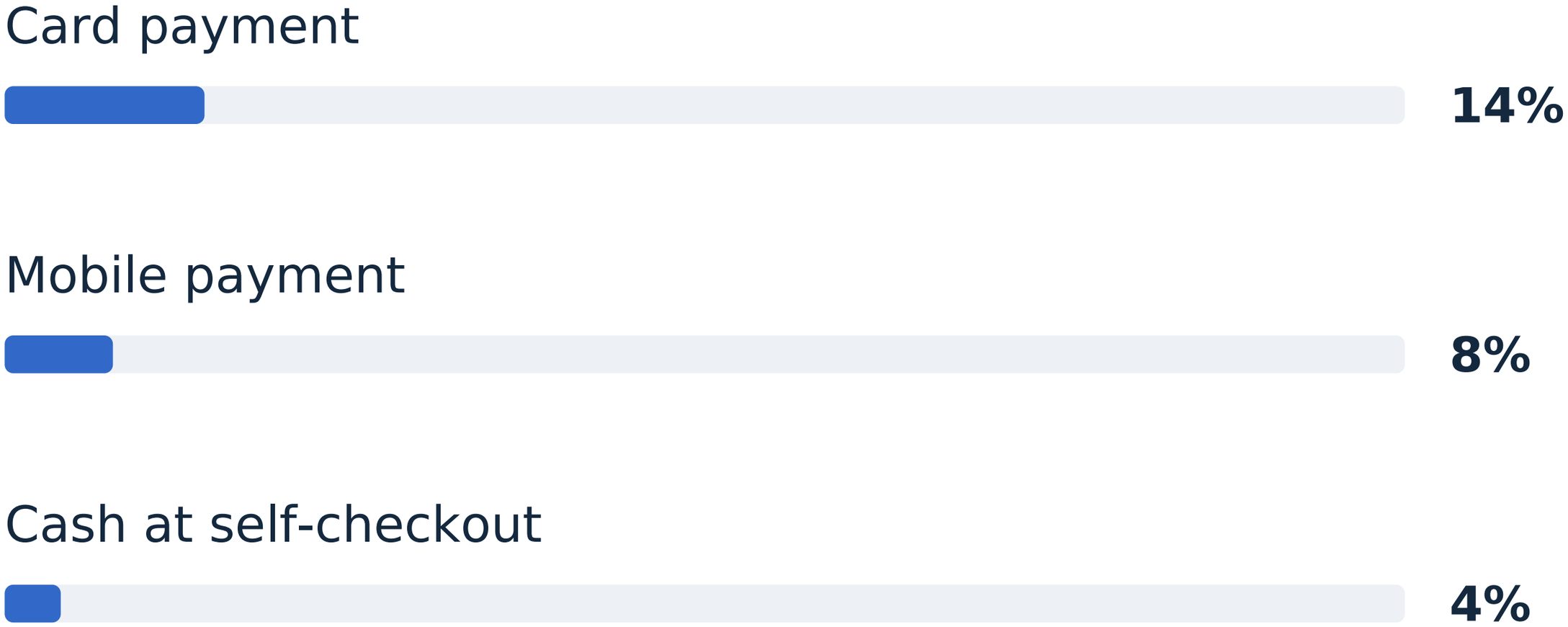
If offered a choice in a shop:

Preference describes what people would like to use. It does not measure their actual transaction share.

Valid n = 40,795. General payment preference.

23% reported in-store technical problems

At least once in the past month:

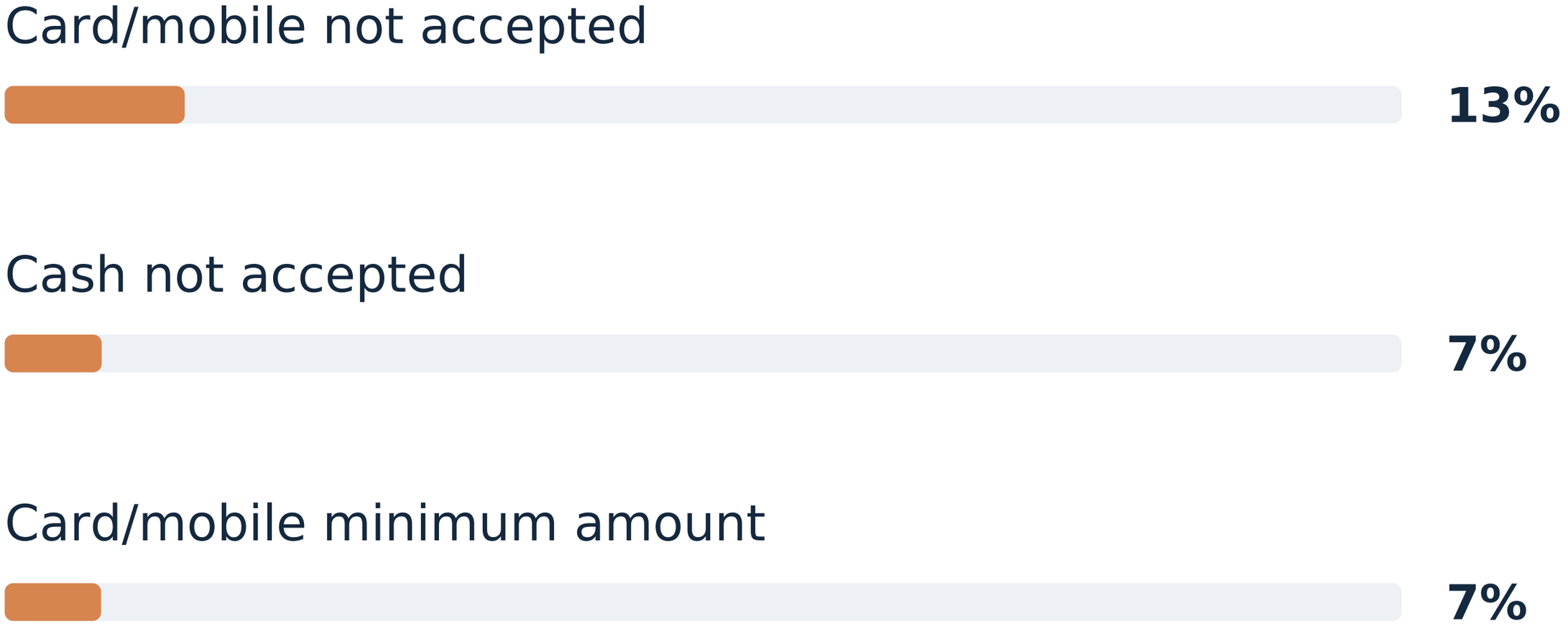


These are shares of valid respondents, not percentages of payments that failed.

Valid n = 39,404. Multiple answers allowed.
Each method uses the same response base.

24% faced a restriction on their preferred method

At least once in the past month:

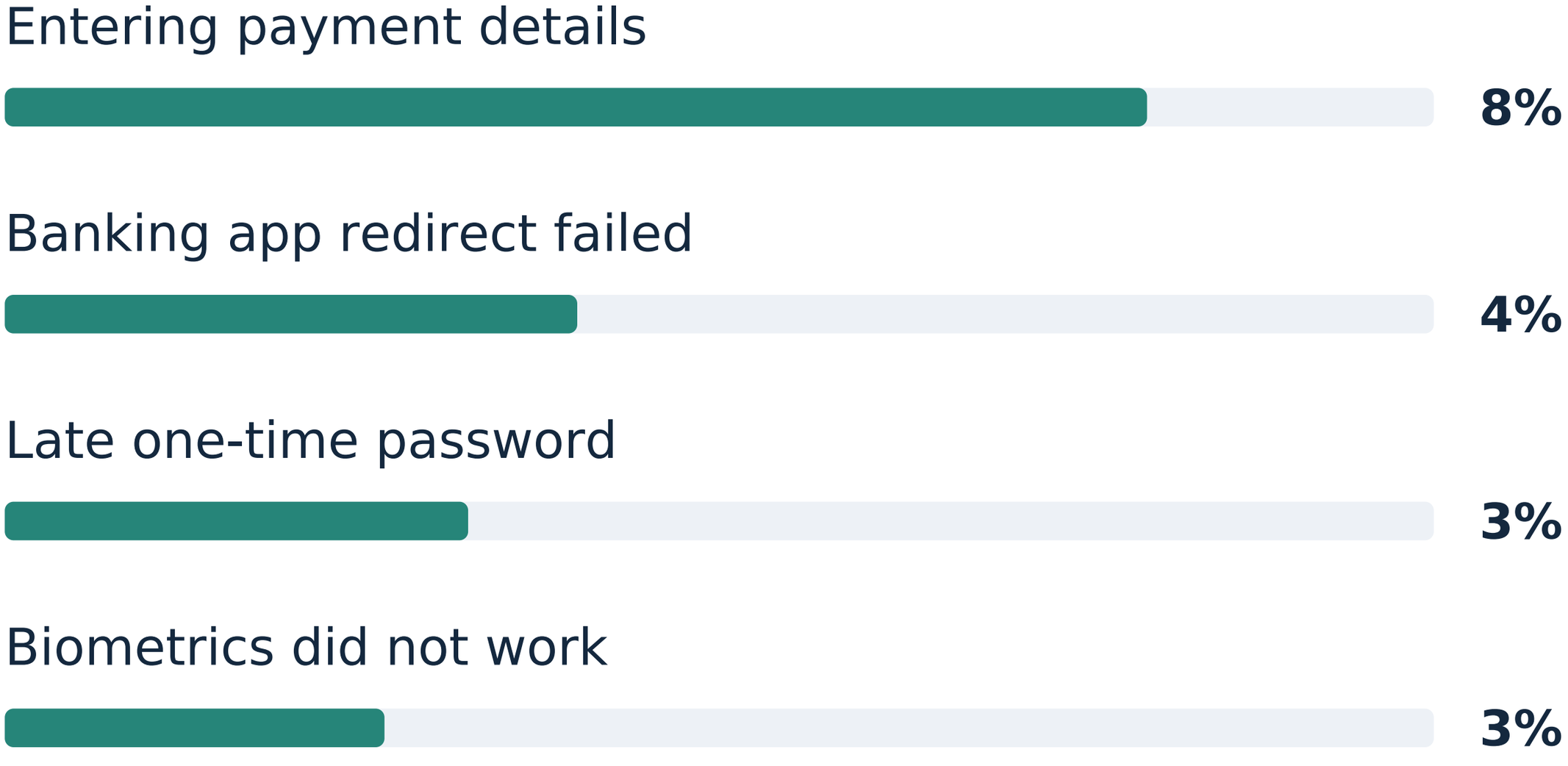


Acceptance policies create a separate customer experience problem from technical failures.

Valid n = 38,719 in-store payment respondents.
Multiple answers allowed.

18% reported difficulty with online payments

Most frequently selected difficulties:

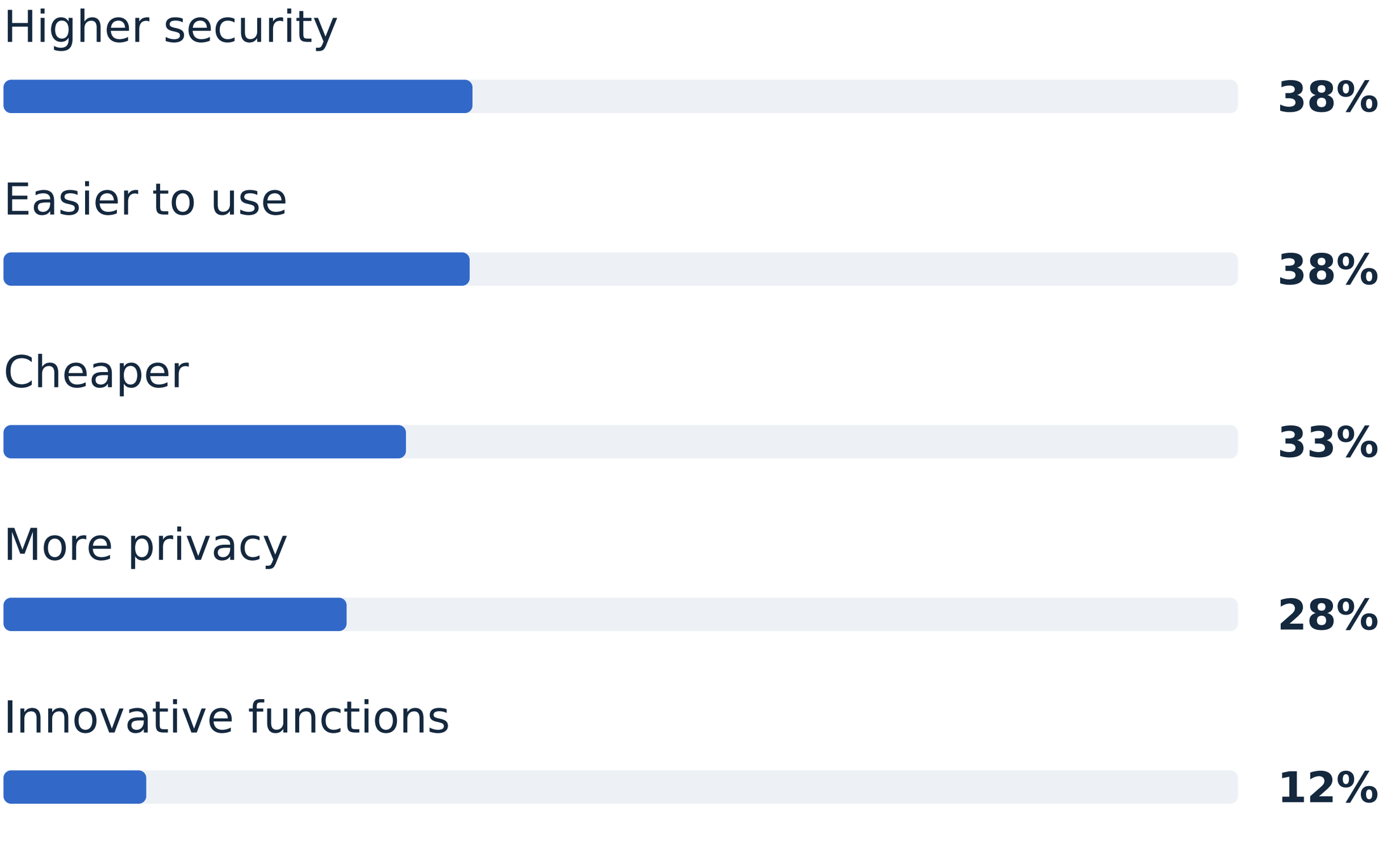


Bars use a 0-10% scale.

Payment forms and authentication recovery both deserve investigation.

Valid n = 13,884 online-difficulty respondents.
Diary-day payments. Multiple answers allowed.

Security and ease lead stated adoption factors



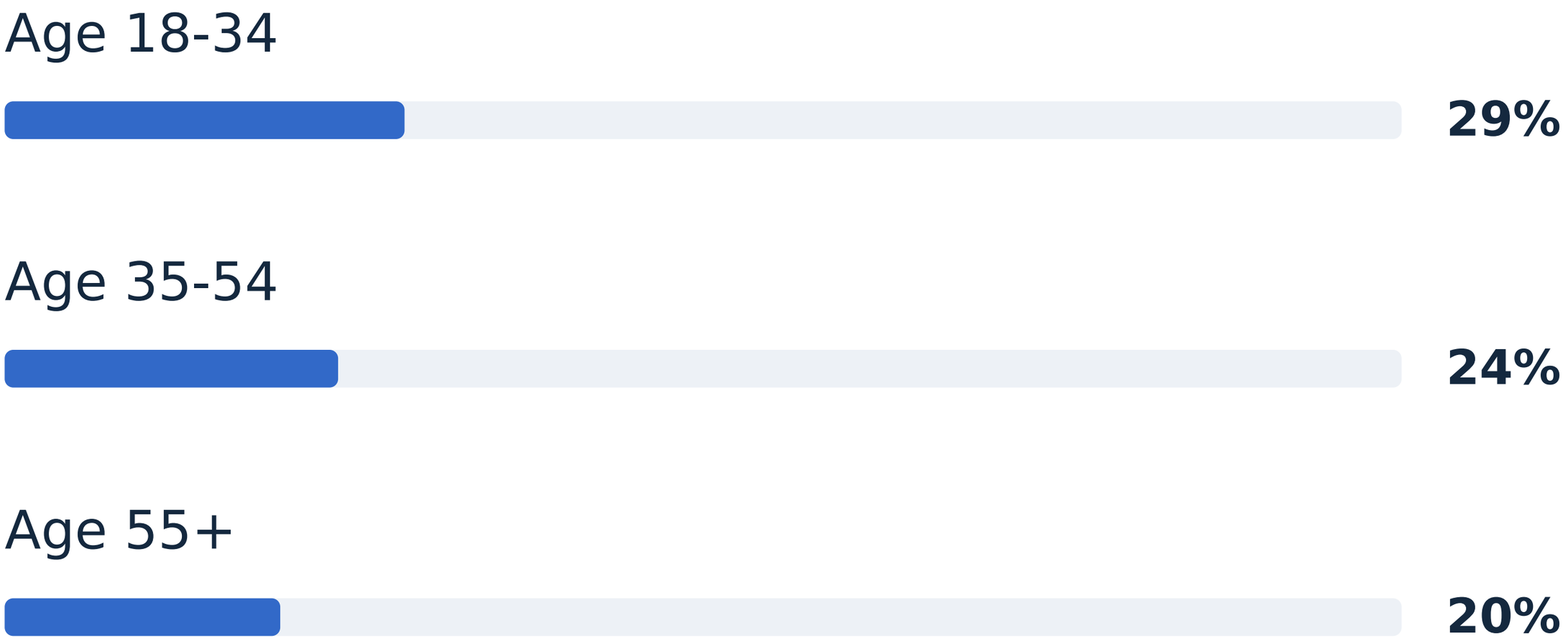
Security and ease are almost tied. These are stated motivations, not measured adoption effects.

Valid n = 39,940. Up to three answers.
Includes respondents not interested in a new solution.

AGE DIFFERENCES

Younger respondents report more problems

Any in-store technical issue in the past month:



Differences in payment use and exposure may contribute. This does not measure digital capability.

Valid n: 10,103 / 13,918 / 15,383.
Holding country mix fixed gives a similar pattern.

The findings suggest three tests

01 Investigate in-store incidents

Link support cases with terminal, network and authorisation logs.

02 Test checkout recovery

Improve form validation and recovery from authentication errors.

03 Test ease with clear security

Assess task completion, comprehension and take-up in a pilot.

These are hypotheses to test. The survey does not estimate revenue uplift or ROI.

The denominator changes the story

A VALID BASE FOR EACH QUESTION

Skipped and non-substantive answers stay outside the primary percentage.

WEIGHTED SHARES, ACTUAL COUNTS

The supplied Gross_weight adjusts the estimates. n counts real responses.

DESCRIPTIVE FINDINGS

No causal effects or formal significance claims. This is the 18-country public file.

The accompanying project includes the executed Python notebook, full metric definitions and reproducible code.

Source and documentation: ECB SPACE 2024